

eyecatchers

Q&A SHRIYA SARAN

SOUTHERN SPICE

At 22, southern siren **Shriya Saran** has not only played lady love to superstar **Rajnikant** in his magnum opus *Sivaji: The Boss*, she is now all set to try her luck in Bollywood again with *Awarapan*.

Q. What was working with Rajnikant like?

A. He is a demi-god. Often you are disappointed on meeting stars but when I met him my admiration quadrupled.

Q. Did you have language problems?

A. I'm a pucca north Indian doing Telugu and Tamil movies. I know Telugu, but someone has to dub for me.

Q. Your first Bollywood film *Shukriya* was a dud.

A. After *Shukriya* I wanted to do good work. Interesting offers came from the south. Now I have some great offers in Bollywood so I've moved to Mumbai.

Q. Does that mean it's goodbye to regional films?

A. We should look at Indian cinema as a whole rather than concentrating on regional differences.

A New Dawn

Call her eye candy or simply Suga Candy, the latest looker doing the rounds of music channels is hot import **Rose Dawn**. The 19-year-old girl from London is creating quite a stir with **Frankfinn Music's** new remix video *Kahin pe nigahen* and is already well-versed with celebrity lingo. "Item numbers can be classy and naughty and need not be raunchy," declares Dawn. Interestingly, the Anglo-Indian beauty claims she knows the basics of Kathak, Bharatanatyam, hip-hop, tap dance, ballet and belly dancing. The dawn of a new dance diva, perhaps?



RECORD ROW

Bhavik Gandhi, 30, a venture capitalist, took 106 days to row a distance of 6,393 km from Spain to Antigua, becoming the first Asian to row solo across the Atlantic Ocean. Born in Mumbai and settled in Stockholm, Sweden, Gandhi set a world record when his boat *Miss Olive* docked at Jabberwock beach on June 14. No mean feat, indeed.



Dance Diva

Daddy dearest may not be nodding in approval, but **Esha Deol** is all set to take the item number route to success. The 24-year-old will shimmy in a "totally filmy" climax song composed and sung by **Shibani Kashyap** for **Rohit Shetty's** forthcoming film *Sunday*. While Shetty says he signed the *Dhoom* babe for her dancing abilities, Deol isn't worried about being tagged an item girl. "I don't have a problem doing it because it's not vulgar and I'm a very confident dancer," she claims.



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■ Compiled by **Kimi Dangor**

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